

Top 5 Current Malware - Research Summary

Current Malware Landscape — Research Summary

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AI Generation: This report was generated with AI assistance and is provided for informational purposes only. All findings, IOCs, detection rules, hunting queries, attribution assessments, and recommendations must be independently reviewed and validated by a qualified security professional before operational use.

1. Selection Methodology

This report set uses ANY.RUN's public Malware Trends Tracker as the primary ranking source because it reflects recent public sandbox submissions and current malware family activity. On 2026-06-01, the tracker listed the top five families as:

Rank	Family	Type	ANY.RUN last-7-day task count shown in tracker
1	XWorm	RAT	483
2	Agent Tesla	Trojan / spyware / stealer	287
3	Remcos	Remote access tool / RAT	257
4	Stealc	Stealer	218
5	LokiBot	Stealer	198

The ranking should be interpreted as "top by current ANY.RUN public sandbox activity," not as a universal global prevalence ranking across all telemetry providers. Red Canary's May 2026 reporting, for example, ranks broader threat clusters rather than only malware families, with ClearFake leading its monthly list.

2. Report Index

- XWorm Malware Report
- Agent Tesla Malware Report
- Remcos Malware Report
- Stealc Malware Report
- LokiBot Malware Report

3. Cross-Family Trends

- Commodity RATs and stealers dominate current public sandbox volume.
- Initial access is heavily social-engineered: phishing attachments, fake CAPTCHA or ClickFix flows, malicious installers, and abused trusted services.
- Credential theft remains the highest business-impact behavior because browser passwords, cookies, tokens, crypto wallets, email profiles, and VPN/RMM credentials can enable follow-on intrusion.
- Dynamic DNS, tunneling services, Pastebin-like staging, and legitimate SMTP/FTP services appear repeatedly; these must be treated as context-dependent indicators, not automatic proof of compromise.
- Detection should prioritize behavior: suspicious script execution, unusual child processes, credential store access, persistence writes, exfiltration protocols, and RAT C2 patterns.

4. Deep Research Methodology

Each family report now uses a deeper research model:

- Current ranking from ANY.RUN public sandbox activity.
- Family behavior from sandbox/intel sources and MITRE ATT&CK where available.
- Recent campaign reporting from vendors and government sources where available.
- Evidence ledger separating sourced claims from analyst assessment.
- Static and dynamic analysis expectations for future sample work.
- Infrastructure confidence model for handling dual-use services.
- Detection engineering across Sigma, KQL, SPL, YARA, and network-hunting concepts where useful.
- Threat hunting hypotheses, triage pivots, IR actions, validation notes, and intelligence gaps.

5. Cross-Family Defensive Priorities

Priority	Rationale	Applies To
Block or alert on browser-to-shell execution	ClickFix and fake CAPTCHA campaigns turn browsers into launch points for script execution.	Stealc, Remcos, LokiBot, XWorm loaders
Monitor direct SMTP/FTP from workstations	Commodity stealers often use mail/file-transfer protocols for exfiltration.	Agent Tesla, LokiBot variants
Treat infostealers as identity incidents	Cookies, tokens, saved credentials, wallets, and mail profiles may remain useful after malware removal.	Agent Tesla, Stealc, LokiBot, XWorm
Inventory authorized remote administration tools	RAT families can masquerade as remote support activity.	Remcos, XWorm
Correlate weak network IOCs with process context	Dynamic DNS, tunnels, Pastebin, Telegram, and SMTP providers are dual-use.	All five
Preserve execution ancestry	Parent-child process lineage is often more durable than final payload hash.	All five

6. Source Limitations

Public rankings and public sandbox submissions are valuable but not universal. They may overrepresent samples submitted by researchers, customers, or automated collectors. Static IOCs also age quickly for commodity malware. The reports therefore favor behavior, telemetry, and validation guidance over long-lived blocklists.

7. Primary Sources

- ANY.RUN Malware Trends Tracker: <https://anyrun.de/malware-trends/>
- ANY.RUN XWorm overview: <https://any.run/malware-trends/xworm/>
- ANY.RUN Agent Tesla overview: <https://any.run/malware-trends/agenttesla/>
- ANY.RUN Remcos overview: <https://any.run/malware-trends/remcos/>
- ANY.RUN Stealc overview: <https://any.run/malware-trends/stealc/>
- ANY.RUN LokiBot overview: <https://any.run/malware-trends/lokiBOT/>
- Red Canary Intelligence Insights, May 2026:
<https://redcanary.com/blog/threat-intelligence/intelligence-insights-may-2026/>
- ANY.RUN Malware Trends Report 2025: <https://any.run/cybersecurity-blog/malware-trends-2025/>
- MITRE ATT&CK Agent Tesla S0331: <https://attack.mitre.org/software/S0331/>
- MITRE ATT&CK Remcos S0332: <https://attack.mitre.org/software/S0332/>
- MITRE ATT&CK LokiBot S0447: <https://attack.mitre.org/software/S0447/>
- CISA LokiBot advisory AA20-266A:
<https://www.cisa.gov/news-events/cybersecurity-advisories/aa20-266a>
- Fortinet Agent Tesla campaign analysis: <https://www.fortinet.com/blog/threat-research/unmasking-agent-tesla-deep-dive-into-multi-stage-campaign>
- Fortinet Remcos 2026 campaign analysis: <https://www.fortinet.com/blog/threat-research/new-remcos-campaign-distributed-through-fake-shipping-document>
- Trellix Remcos fileless campaign analysis:
<https://www.trellix.com/blogs/research/fileless-multi-stage-remcos-rat-phishing-to-memory/>
- LevelBlue Fake CAPTCHA campaign analysis: <https://www.levelblue.com/blogs/spiderlabs-blog/fake-captcha-campaign-inside-a-multi-stage-stealer-assault>
- CyberProof ClickFix campaign analysis:
<https://www.cyberproof.com/blog/fake-captcha-attack-uncovered-clickfix-infostealer-campaign/>
- SentinelOne ClickFix research: <https://www.sentinelone.com/blog/how-clickfix-is-weaponizing-verification-fatigue-to-deliver-rats-infostealers/>
- Netlas fake prompts research: https://netlas.io/blog/fake_prompts/